STATECRAFT INSTITUTE FOR CLIMATE & DEVELOPMENT POLICY (SICDP)

Cross-Border Roundtable Operational Blueprint

Institutional Strategy, Delegation Management, and Handout Core Framework

Thematic Track:	Technology & State Capacity Track
Core Research:	"Premature Automation: Institutional Preconditions for AI-Enabled Public Services in South Asia"
Target Venue:	IIT Kharagpur Kolkata Extension Centre, Salt Lake City, West Bengal, India
Delegation Size:	8 Members (2 Active Panel Table, 6 Back-Row Operations/Gallery)

1. Executive Strategy & Intellectual Asset Protection

This operational document formalizes the strategic framework for executing a high-impact, land-based institutional transit from Dhaka, Bangladesh to Kolkata, India. The primary objective is to host an expert academic-policy dialogue with senior faculty members at the Indian Institute of Technology (IIT) Kharagpur.

Intellectual Property Safeguards: Because the primary research asset—*"Premature Automation.pdf"*—is an unpublished working abstract and a book chapter under active development, the roundtable is structurally framed as an **Expert Stress-Test** rather than a passive presentation. By utilizing a highly specific "Thematic Anchoring" design, the delegation introduces conceptual definitions while purposefully withholding underlying empirical data, case mechanics, and proprietary research configurations.

The resulting published *Roundtable Proceedings* under **The Statecraft Papers** imprint establishes a hard, publicly dated paper trail. This legal and academic mechanism anchors the primary authorship directly to the core authors at the University of Dhaka, while absorbing elite regional feedback into the working text before its final press publication.

2. Executive Agenda & Strategic Timeline (90 Minutes)

The roundtable operates strictly under **Chatham House Rules** to foster candid technocratic and administrative criticism from the host faculty.

Timeline	Session Block & Core Focus	Strategic Objective & Faculty Prompts
00:00 - 00:15	**Session 1: Formalizing the Sequencing Error**	Introduce the structural analogy derived from Dani Rodrik's macroeconomic framework. Establish how applying AI layers over fragile institutional frameworks creates an algorithmic mask rather than resolving fundamental administrative failures.

Timeline	Session Block & Core Focus	Strategic Objective & Faculty Prompts
00:15 - 00:45	**Session 2: The Algorithmic Bottleneck** Opaque Accountability & Encoded Exclusion	Analyze structural failure modes wherein administrative discretion transitions to black-box scripts, leaving citizens without legal recourse, and encoding pre-existing socioeconomic data gaps into permanent denial of access.
00:45 - 01:15	**Session 3: Fragility of State Capacity** Systemic Dependency & Deskilling	Deconstruct the sovereign risk of "borrowed capacity" from private tech vendors (vendor lock-in) and the atrophy of manual troubleshooting capabilities among frontline bureaucratic workforces during technical failures.
01:15 - 01:30	**Session 4: Policy Output Mapping & Close**	Synthesize immediate diagnostic observations. Coordinate the joint rapporteur tracking lines to transition session notes cleanly into the final published proceedings.

3. 8-Person Delegation Command & Protocol Matrix

To project maximum institutional weight without cluttering the intellectual dynamics of the session, the delegation enforces a strict **Front Row vs. Gallery Split**. Only the Core Table Team actively engages in the verbal debate, while the remaining five members run real-time support, note-taking, and logistical tracking.

Deployment Layer	Allocated Count	Operational Responsibility & Protocols
Core Table Team (Front Row)	2 Members	• **Principal Presenter (Lead Author):** Delivers the introductory framework, handles intellectual fencing, and guides answers to faculty counter-prompts. • **Session Moderator:** Formally opens the dialogue, enforces the timing blocks, and transitions the floor between speakers.
Multi-Angle Rapporteurs (Gallery Row)	2 Members	• **Rapporteur A (Legal/Tech Track):** Captures verbatim legal and administrative phrasing from the faculty to protect and refine the framework. • **Rapporteur B (Policy Output Track):** Documents structural synthesis and regional recommendations for the final Proceedings layout.
Operational Support (Gallery Row)	4 Members	• **Time & Pace Manager (1):** Monitors active speaking clocks and issues subtle visual hand signals to the Moderator. • **Media & Tech Coordinators (2):** Manage digital audio recording channels, check data backups, and coordinate digital/physical slide distribution. • **Logistics Director (1):** Manages local cross-border transits, vehicle coordination, expense accounting, and hotel check-in grids.

4. FACULTY HANDOUT TEXT: 4-PAGE WORKING BRIEF THEME TEMPLATE

The following block details the exact material to be laid out at the committee seats prior to the commencement of the event.

THE STATECRAFT PAPERS (2026) • WORKING CHAPTER FORTHCOMING
SICDP TECHNOLOGY & STATE CAPACITY POLICY TRACK
[CONFIDENTIAL WORKING DRAFT - FOR EXPERT DISCUSSION PURPOSES ONLY]
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PREMATURE AUTOMATION: INSTITUTIONAL PRECONDITIONS FOR AI-ENABLED PUBLIC SERVICES IN SOUTH ASIA

Authors: Md. Imam Hossain Shihab & Shuaib Ahmed Araf (Department of Public Administration, University of Dhaka)

I. FRAMEWORK ABSTRACT & MACROECONOMIC ANALOGY
This paper formalizes a diagnostic model investigating the structural limitations of deploying Artificial Intelligence (AI) and complex automated systems within developing public sectors. Drawing an analytical analogy from Dani Rodrik's framework of *premature deindustrialization*, we conceptualize **"Premature Automation"** as a profound institutional sequencing error: the implementation of high-tier technocratic architectures on top of fragile or unformed administrative foundations. We argue that automation does not circumvent institutional maturation; rather, it algorithmically entrenches pre-existing structural failures.

II. CORE FAILURE MODES IDENTIFIED
1. Opaque Accountability (The Black-Box Bureaucracy): Discretionary decision-making shifts from human-centric, legally accountable officials to non-transparent algorithmic models, neutralizing administrative review mechanisms.
2. Encoded Exclusion (Data Legacy Flaws): Marginalized communities lacking stable digital architecture find their historical structural exclusion systematically codified directly into centralized state verification layers.
3. Systemic Dependency (The Sovereign Vendor Trap): The public sector’s technical deficits mandate a structural reliance on private tech providers, transferring long-term custody of core sovereign digital infrastructure to third-party vendors.
4. Administrative Deskilling (Loss of Operational Resilience): Frontline administrative workforces undergo deep task-atrophy due to over-automation, leading to a complete systemic breakdown when digital platforms face operational outages.

III. SOUTH ASIAN COMPARATIVE TRAJECTORIES
• *Bangladesh:* Rapid, hyper-centralized Digital Public Infrastructure (DPI) expansions exposing high risks of Encoded Exclusion.
• *India:* Extensive biometric centralization models highlighting deep challenges in Opaque Accountability and administrative law.
• *Pakistan:* Fragmented and decentralized provincial rollout rates exhibiting pronounced trends toward Frontline Administrative Deskilling.

IV. CONSULTATION PROMPTS FOR PANEL STRESS-TEST

1. **The Administrative Law Gap:** How can contemporary administrative structures dismantle algorithmic immunity when black-box engines produce public service delivery failures?
2. **The Threshold Metric:** What structural and capacity-based benchmarks must a state entity satisfy before automating key social safety nets or legal services?
3. **The Resiliency Safeguard:** How can public infrastructure embed active "manual overrides" to ensure public servants retain critical troubleshooting capacity?